

GED Social Studies Practice Test 6

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC6-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state law requires polling places to provide curbside voting for voters who cannot enter the building because of a disability. Election workers must bring the same ballot materials to the voter's vehicle and follow the same identity and ballot-security procedures used inside the polling place.

Which civic goal is most directly supported by this law?

- A) Equal access to the voting process
- B) Expansion of military authority
- C) Replacement of state elections with federal appointments
- D) Elimination of secret ballots

GED-SOC6-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A consumer price index for a city changed over three years.

Year: 2021, 2022, 2023

Index: 100, 108, 114

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Prices generally rose from 2021 to 2023.
- B) Prices generally fell from 2021 to 2023.
- C) The index stayed the same each year.
- D) Prices doubled between 2021 and 2023.

GED-SOC6-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In 1787, Congress passed a law for governing territory northwest of the Ohio River. The law described how territories could eventually become states and stated that public education should be encouraged. It also prohibited slavery in that territory. The law showed that the national government could shape the development of western lands.

Which conclusion is best supported by this source?

- A) The national government created a process for western territories to become states.
- B) The law ended all disagreement about slavery in the United States.
- C) The law gave western territories power to make treaties with foreign countries.
- D) The national government refused to take any role in western settlement.

GED-SOC6-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country's largest cities are located along a broad inland plain. The plain has deep soils, moderate rainfall, and several navigable rivers that connect farms to markets. Mountain regions in the same country have smaller settlements because transportation is more difficult.

Which statement best explains the settlement pattern?

- A) Fertile land and river transportation encouraged larger settlements on the plain.
- B) Mountain regions always have more people than plains.
- C) Rainfall and rivers have no effect on settlement.
- D) Cities can develop only on ocean coastlines.

GED-SOC6-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state creates an independent election board to test voting machines before election day. The board must use a written checklist, document any machine errors, and remove machines that fail testing.

Which TWO statements best explain the civic purpose of this process?

- A) It helps protect the accuracy of election results.
- B) It creates procedures that election officials must follow consistently.
- C) It allows election workers to change vote totals after ballots are cast.
- D) It removes the need for voters to cast ballots.
- E) It lets political parties decide which ballots are counted.

GED-SOC6-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A business association argues that a state rule requiring different labels on products sold inside the state creates confusion and raises costs. The group says products often move across state lines, so national standards are better for interstate commerce.

Source B:

A state consumer official argues that the state label rule gives residents clearer information about products they buy. The official says states should be able to protect consumers when national law does not directly address a local concern.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether states should be allowed to coin money
- B) Whether product labeling should be mainly uniform nationally or shaped by state consumer rules
- C) Whether businesses should be banned from selling goods across state lines
- D) Whether consumers should be prevented from reading labels

GED-SOC6-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

During the 1840s, supporters of territorial expansion argued that adding western lands would increase trade, farming opportunities, and national power. Critics warned that expansion could intensify conflict over slavery and lead to war with neighboring countries.

Which historical issue is most clearly described?

- A) The debate over territorial expansion before the Civil War
- B) The debate over radio broadcasting in the 1920s
- C) The debate over creating Medicare in the 1960s
- D) The debate over joining the United Nations after World War II

GED-SOC6-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A law that treats people differently based on race would usually be reviewed under the constitutional principle of [D1], which is connected to the [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) equal protection | eminent domain | naturalization

D2) Fourteenth Amendment | Third Amendment | commerce clause

GED-SOC6-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A worker earned \$50,000 in 2022 and \$53,000 in 2023. What was the percent increase in earnings? Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC6-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A city built near a major aquifer has grown rapidly. As population increased, wells pumped more groundwater than rainfall could replace. Some neighborhoods now report lower water levels and land sinking slowly in certain areas.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Rapid population growth can place stress on groundwater resources.
- B) Aquifers are not affected by human water use.
- C) Urban growth always increases groundwater levels.
- D) Land sinking occurs only near ocean beaches.

GED-SOC6-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

Congress passes a law regulating safety standards for trucks that carry goods between states. The law applies to companies that use interstate highways to ship products from one state to another.

Which constitutional power most directly supports this law?

- A) Power to regulate interstate commerce
- B) Power to appoint state mayors
- C) Power to conduct local zoning hearings
- D) Power to ratify state constitutions

GED-SOC6-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows membership in a national women's suffrage organization.

Year: 1890, 1900, 1910

Members: 13,000, 25,000, 75,000

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Membership grew substantially from 1890 to 1910.
- B) Membership decreased after 1890.
- C) Membership was highest in 1890.
- D) Membership stayed the same in each year.

GED-SOC6-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A city ordinance says that food trucks may operate in commercial districts if they meet health, parking, and fire-safety rules. The ordinance does not ban food trucks, but it sets conditions for operating in shared public spaces.

Which statement best describes the purpose of this ordinance?

- A) To regulate local business activity for public health and safety
- B) To give the city power to declare war
- C) To prevent all private businesses from operating
- D) To allow courts to write city budgets

GED-SOC6-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A country's currency loses value compared with another country's currency. As a result, goods imported from that country become more expensive for consumers, while the country's exports may become cheaper for foreign buyers.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Exchange rates can affect the cost of imports and the competitiveness of exports.
- B) Currency values have no effect on international trade.
- C) Imports always become cheaper when a currency loses value.
- D) Exports always stop when exchange rates change.

GED-SOC6-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A public university allows student groups to reserve meeting rooms. The university may set neutral rules about room size, cleanup, and scheduling, but it may not deny a group's request simply because officials disagree with the group's political views.

Which constitutional idea is most closely connected to this policy?

- A) Government rules may regulate logistics but should not discriminate based on viewpoint.
- B) Public universities may ban all political discussion.
- C) Only government officials may hold political meetings.
- D) Student groups have no connection to speech rights.

GED-SOC6-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

In the early 1900s, many workers in garment factories faced long hours, low pay, and unsafe buildings. After several widely reported industrial accidents, reformers pushed for workplace inspections, fire-safety rules, and limits on child labor.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Industrial working conditions helped motivate labor and safety reforms.
- B) Public concern increased pressure for government regulation of workplaces.
- C) Factory accidents ended all industrial employment in the United States.
- D) Reformers argued that children should work longer hours.
- E) Workplace safety was unrelated to Progressive Era reform.

GED-SOC6-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country reports the following exports.

Export: Wheat, Copper, Software services, Textiles

Value: \$12 billion, \$18 billion, \$27 billion, \$9 billion

Which export has the highest value?

- A) Wheat
- B) Copper
- C) Software services
- D) Textiles

GED-SOC6-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A town requires building entrances used by the public to include ramps or other accessible routes unless the structure qualifies for a narrow safety exception. The town says the rule helps people with disabilities use public services and businesses.

Which civic principle is best reflected in this rule?

- A) Equal access under the law
- B) State control of foreign treaties
- C) Executive immunity from lawsuits
- D) Legislative punishment without trial

GED-SOC6-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city reports annual sales tax revenue.

Year: 2021, 2022, 2023

Sales tax revenue: \$24 million, \$27 million, \$30 million

By how many million dollars did revenue increase from 2021 to 2023?

- A) \$3 million
- B) \$6 million
- C) \$24 million
- D) \$30 million

GED-SOC6-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The passage of the Nineteenth Amendment expanded [D1] by prohibiting denial of the vote based on [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) voting rights | presidential veto power | tariff collection

D2) sex | property ownership | military service

GED-SOC6-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A county reports ballots cast by age group.

Age group: 18–29, 30–49, 50–64, 65+

Ballots cast: 4,800, 9,600, 7,200, 6,400

How many ballots were cast in total?

- A) 21,600
- B) 24,000
- C) 28,000
- D) 30,400

GED-SOC6-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state requires that proposed constitutional amendments appear on the ballot with a short plain-language summary. The summary must explain the main effect of the amendment without telling voters how to vote.

What is the main purpose of this requirement?

- A) To help voters understand the proposal before casting a ballot
- B) To let judges vote in place of citizens
- C) To require all voters to support the amendment
- D) To remove amendments from the election process

GED-SOC6-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A bank offers a savings account that pays interest. A customer deposits money and leaves it in the account for a year. At the end of the year, the bank adds interest to the balance.

Which personal finance concept is shown?

- A) Earning interest on savings
- B) Judicial review
- C) Population density
- D) Legislative apportionment

GED-SOC6-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the late 1800s and early 1900s, many immigrants arrived in U.S. cities where they found work, formed neighborhoods, and built religious, cultural, and mutual-aid organizations. At the same time, some native-born Americans supported laws limiting immigration and argued that newcomers would not assimilate.

Which broader historical pattern is shown by this source?

- A) Immigration reshaped urban communities while also producing political backlash.
- B) Immigration ended all cultural change in cities.
- C) Immigrants avoided creating community institutions.
- D) Native-born Americans unanimously supported open immigration.

GED-SOC6-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Primary election
- B) General election
- C) Ballot measure
- D) Electoral district

Targets:

T1) Voters choose among candidates nominated for public office.

T2) Voters in a party choose which candidate will represent that party.

T3) Voters decide directly on a proposed law or constitutional change.

GED-SOC6-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region has large deposits of rare minerals used in batteries. Mining companies bring jobs and roads, but local communities worry about water pollution and the loss of farmland.

Which issue is most clearly described?

A) Resource extraction can create economic benefits and environmental concerns.

B) Mineral resources prevent all economic development.

C) Mining has no relationship to transportation.

D) Farmland cannot be affected by industrial activity.

GED-SOC6-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A person born in another country completes the legal process to become a U.S. citizen. After becoming a citizen, the person may vote in federal elections, serve on a jury if called, and apply for certain public offices.

Which statement best describes the result of this process?

A) Naturalization grants citizenship with important rights and responsibilities.

B) Naturalization gives a person power to veto federal laws.

C) Naturalization allows a person to appoint Supreme Court justices.

D) Naturalization removes all civic responsibilities.

GED-SOC6-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state law allows counties to set school calendars, but it requires every county to provide at least 180 instructional days. One county wants a shorter school year. A court rules that the county must follow the statewide minimum.

Which statement best explains the ruling?

A) Local governments must operate within authority granted by state law.

B) Counties may ignore all state education laws.

C) School calendars are controlled only by foreign treaties.

D) Courts cannot interpret state education requirements.

GED-SOC6-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

During the 1970s, rising energy prices led many Americans to wait in long lines for gasoline. Policymakers debated fuel efficiency, domestic energy production, conservation, and dependence on foreign oil.

Which issue is most clearly reflected in this source?

- A) Energy supply affected both daily life and national policy debates.
- B) Gasoline became unnecessary for transportation in the 1970s.
- C) Energy prices had no influence on government policy.
- D) The United States ended all foreign trade in the 1970s.

GED-SOC6-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state reports the results of a ballot measure.

Vote: Yes, No

Number of votes: 1,260,000, 840,000

What percentage of votes were Yes votes?

- A) 40%
- B) 50%
- C) 60%
- D) 75%

GED-SOC6-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city requires restaurants to post maximum occupancy signs based on fire-safety inspections. The rule applies to all restaurants of similar size and building type.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this rule?

- A) Protecting public safety through generally applied local regulation
- B) Allowing restaurants to write criminal laws
- C) Giving the city power to appoint federal judges
- D) Preventing all business activity in the city

GED-SOC6-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state education agency reports graduation rates.

Year: 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023

Graduation rate: 82%, 84%, 83%, 86%

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) The graduation rate was highest in 2023.
- B) The graduation rate increased every single year.
- C) The graduation rate in 2022 was lower than in 2021.
- D) The graduation rate was 90% in 2023.
- E) The graduation rate was lowest in 2022.

GED-SOC6-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A public school district allows community groups to use school auditoriums after hours. A civic group is denied access only because it plans to discuss a controversial public issue. A court rules that once the district opened the space to community groups, it could not exclude one group solely because of its viewpoint.

Which conclusion is best supported by the ruling?

- A) Government may not apply access rules in a way that discriminates against a viewpoint.
- B) Public schools must close all buildings after school hours.
- C) Community groups have no ability to discuss public issues.
- D) Courts may not review rules involving public buildings.

GED-SOC6-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows the percentage of U.S. households with personal computers.

Year: 1985, 1995, 2005

Households with personal computers: 8%, 35%, 68%

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Personal computer ownership increased greatly between 1985 and 2005.
- B) Personal computer ownership declined after 1985.
- C) Personal computer ownership was highest in 1985.
- D) Personal computer ownership stayed below 10% in 2005.

GED-SOC6-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires each bill passed by the legislature to have a title that describes its main subject. Courts use this requirement to prevent lawmakers from hiding unrelated provisions inside a bill with a misleading title.

Which claim is best supported by this source?

- A) Clear bill titles help lawmakers and citizens understand what legislation addresses.
- B) Bill titles are designed to hide the purpose of legislation.
- C) Courts require every bill to include unrelated subjects.
- D) Legislatures are not allowed to pass bills.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC6-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Equal access to the voting process —

Explanation: Curbside voting helps voters with disabilities participate using the same ballot-security procedures.

GED-SOC6-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Prices generally rose from 2021 to 2023. —

Explanation: The index increased from 100 to 108 to 114, showing general price increases.

GED-SOC6-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The national government created a process for western territories to become states. — Explanation: The source describes a law that governed western territory and set a path to statehood.

GED-SOC6-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Fertile land and river transportation encouraged larger settlements on the plain. — Explanation: Deep soils, rainfall, and navigable rivers helped support settlement and trade.

GED-SOC6-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: It helps protect the accuracy of election results. | It creates procedures that election officials must follow consistently. — Explanation: Testing machines and following a written checklist support accurate and consistent election administration.

GED-SOC6-006 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Whether product labeling should be mainly uniform nationally or shaped by state consumer rules — Explanation: Source A favors national uniformity for interstate commerce, while Source B supports state consumer protection rules.

GED-SOC6-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The debate over territorial expansion before the Civil War — Explanation: The source describes expansion arguments and concerns about slavery and conflict with neighboring countries.

GED-SOC6-008 — Correct: D1=equal protection; D2=Fourteenth Amendment — Correct Answer: D1=equal protection; D2=Fourteenth Amendment — Explanation: The Equal Protection Clause of the Fourteenth Amendment applies to laws that treat people differently, especially based on race.

GED-SOC6-009 — Correct: 6 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 6 — Explanation: The increase is \$3,000; \$3,000 divided by \$50,000 equals 6%.

GED-SOC6-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Rapid population growth can place stress on groundwater resources. — Explanation: The scenario links increased pumping to lower groundwater levels and land sinking.

GED-SOC6-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Power to regulate interstate commerce — Explanation: Trucks carrying goods between states are part of interstate commerce.

GED-SOC6-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Membership grew substantially from 1890 to 1910. — Explanation: Membership increased from 13,000 to 75,000.

GED-SOC6-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: To regulate local business activity for public health and safety — Explanation: The ordinance sets health, parking, and fire-safety rules for food trucks operating locally.

GED-SOC6-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Exchange rates can affect the cost of imports and the competitiveness of exports. — Explanation: A weaker currency can make imports more expensive and exports cheaper for foreign buyers.

GED-SOC6-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Government rules may regulate logistics but should not discriminate based on viewpoint. — Explanation: Neutral scheduling and room-use rules are allowed, but viewpoint discrimination is not.

GED-SOC6-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Industrial working conditions helped motivate labor and safety reforms. | Public concern increased pressure for government regulation of workplaces. — Explanation: Unsafe factories and reported accidents helped drive workplace inspection and safety reforms.

GED-SOC6-017 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: Software services — Explanation: Software services have the highest export value at \$27 billion.

GED-SOC6-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Equal access under the law — Explanation: Accessibility rules help people with disabilities use public services and businesses.

GED-SOC6-019 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: \$6 million — Explanation: Revenue rose from \$24 million to \$30 million, an increase of \$6 million.

GED-SOC6-020 — Correct: D1=voting rights; D2=sex — Correct Answer: D1=voting rights; D2=sex — Explanation: The Nineteenth Amendment prohibits denial of the vote based on sex.

GED-SOC6-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 28,000 — Explanation: $4,800 + 9,600 + 7,200 + 6,400 = 28,000$.

GED-SOC6-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: To help voters understand the proposal before casting a ballot — Explanation: A plain-language summary helps voters understand what an amendment would do.

GED-SOC6-023 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Earning interest on savings — Explanation: The bank adds interest to money kept in the savings account.

GED-SOC6-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Immigration reshaped urban communities while also producing political backlash. — Explanation: The source describes immigrant communities and organizations as well as support for restrictive laws.

GED-SOC6-025 — Correct: T1=B; T2=A; T3=C — Correct Answer: T1=General election; T2=Primary election; T3=Ballot measure — Explanation: A general election chooses among nominated candidates, a primary selects a party's candidate, and a ballot measure lets voters decide directly on a proposal.

GED-SOC6-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Resource extraction can create economic benefits and environmental concerns. — Explanation: Mining provides jobs and infrastructure but raises concerns about pollution and farmland loss.

GED-SOC6-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Naturalization grants citizenship with important rights and responsibilities. — Explanation: Naturalization allows a person to become a citizen with rights such as voting and responsibilities such as jury service.

GED-SOC6-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Local governments must operate within authority granted by state law. — Explanation: Counties are local governments and must follow statewide legal requirements.

GED-SOC6-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Energy supply affected both daily life and national policy debates. — Explanation: The source links gasoline lines and energy prices to policy debates over production, conservation, and dependence.

GED-SOC6-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 60% — Explanation: Total votes were 2,100,000; 1,260,000 divided by 2,100,000 equals 60%.

GED-SOC6-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Protecting public safety through generally applied local regulation — Explanation: Occupancy rules are local safety regulations applied to similar restaurants.

GED-SOC6-032 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: The graduation rate was highest in 2023. | The graduation rate in 2022 was lower than in 2021. — Explanation: The highest rate was 86% in 2023, and 83% in 2022 was lower than 84% in 2021.

GED-SOC6-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Government may not apply access rules in a way that discriminates against a viewpoint. — Explanation: Once the district opened the space, it could not exclude a group solely because of its viewpoint.

GED-SOC6-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Personal computer ownership increased greatly between 1985 and 2005. — Explanation: Ownership rose from 8% to 68%.

GED-SOC6-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Clear bill titles help lawmakers and citizens understand what legislation addresses. — Explanation: The title requirement helps prevent unrelated provisions from being hidden in misleading legislation.